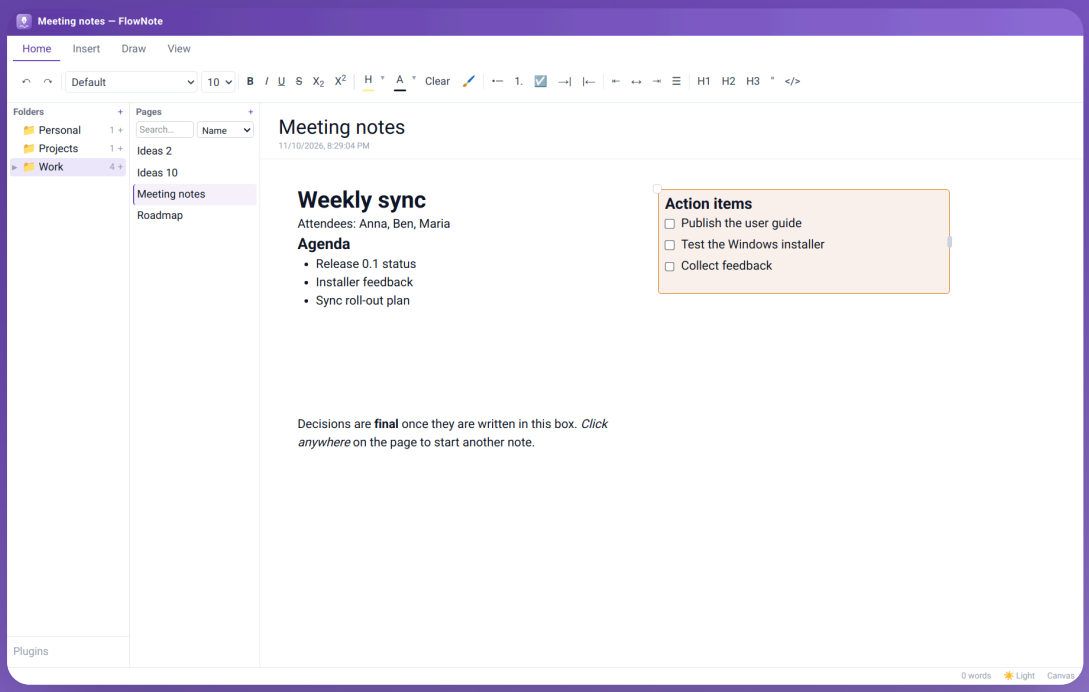
INSTALLATION GUIDE

FlowNote

Step-by-step instructions to install, update and uninstall FlowNote on Linux and Windows.



Version 0.1.0

Linux · Windows

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1. Before you start

1.1 Which file do I need?

Your computer	Download	Size
Linux (64-bit)	`FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.run` : one-file installer (recommended) or `FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.tar.gz` : the same, as a folder	≈ 185 MB
Windows 10 / 11 (64-bit)	`FlowNote-<version>-windows-x64.zip` : setup wizard, MSI package and uninstaller	< 100 MB

Not sure if your computer is 64-bit? On Linux run `uname -m` in a terminal; it should print `x86_64`. On Windows open **Settings** → **System** → **About** and look for *64-bit operating system*.

1.2 System requirements

	Linux	Windows
Operating system	Any 64-bit distribution. The *system-wide* install needs a Debian/Ubuntu-based one (Ubuntu, Debian, Linux Mint, Pop!_OS, elementary…).	Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
Disk space	≈ 280 MB (system-wide) or ≈ 110 MB (just for me)	Less than 100 MB
Permissions	Your password only for the system-wide install	No administrator rights for the setup wizard; the MSI needs them
Other	A desktop session. For graphical installer windows, `zenity` or `kdialog` (most desktops have one)	Microsoft Edge WebView2 (built into Windows 11; added automatically on Windows 10)

1.3 Already using FlowNote?

You don't need to uninstall first. Installing a newer version **upgrades** FlowNote in place and **keeps all your notes**. If you want an extra safety copy, see *Backing up your notes* in chapter 4.

1.4 Optional: check the download

Each download comes with checksums so you can confirm it isn't damaged:

```
# Linux, in the download folder
$ sha256sum -c FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.sha256
FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.run: OK
```

```
# Windows PowerShell — compare with the value in FlowNote-<version>-windows-
x64.zip.sha256
PS> Get-FileHash .\FlowNote-<version>-windows-x64.zip -Algorithm SHA256
```

2. Installing on Linux

Choose **one** of the three methods below. Method A is the easiest.

2.1 Method A: one-file installer (graphical)

1. **Download** `FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.run` (for example into your *Downloads* folder).
2. **Allow it to run.** In your file manager, right-click the file → **Properties** → **Permissions** → tick **Allow executing file as program** (in KDE Dolphin: *Is executable*). Close the dialog.
3. **Double-click** the file. If your file manager asks what to do, choose **Run** (not *Display* or *Open in text editor*).
4. **Welcome.** A FlowNote window shows the version being installed. Click **OK**.
5. **Release notice.** Read it and click **Continue** (*Cancel* stops without changing anything).
6. **Choose the install type** and click **OK**:
   - **For everyone on this computer**: a normal system package. You'll be asked for your password in the next step. Recommended on Ubuntu, Debian and Mint.
   - **Just for me**: no password, works on every distribution, installed in your home folder.
7. **Enter your password** if asked (system-wide install only), then wait while a progress window is shown. This takes from a few seconds to a minute.
8. **Finished.** The last window says where FlowNote was installed and asks *Start FlowNote now?* Click **Yes** to open it.

> **Tip**
> From now on, open FlowNote from your application menu: look for **FlowNote** under *Office*, or search for "FlowNote".

2.2 Method B: one-file installer in a terminal

The same installer asks the same questions as text when you run it in a terminal. Type the answer and press `Enter`; pressing `Enter` alone takes the default (marked `*` or written in capitals, like `[Y/n]`).

1. Open a terminal in the download folder (right-click inside the folder → **Open in Terminal**, or `cd ~/Downloads`).
2. Make the installer executable and start it:

```
$ chmod +x FlowNote-*.run
$ ./FlowNote-*.run
```

3. Answer the questions. A typical session looks like this:

```
Welcome to the FlowNote 0.1.0 installer.
...
Continue? [Y/n] y
How do you want to install FlowNote?
  1) * For everyone on this computer (system package, needs your password)
  2)   Just for me (anna), no password needed
Choose 1-2 [default: the one marked *, q to cancel]: 2
==> Copying FlowNote to /home/anna/.local/opt/flownote
==> Adding FlowNote to the app menu
==> FlowNote 0.1.0 is installed for anna (in /home/anna/.local/opt/flownote).
Start FlowNote now? [Y/n] y
```

4. If you chose *For everyone*, type your password when `sudo` asks for it (nothing appears on screen while you type; that's normal).

2.3 Method C: from the bundle folder

Use this if you downloaded the `.tar.gz`, or want to install without any questions (for example on several computers).

1. Unpack the bundle and go into its folder:

```
$ tar xzf FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.tar.gz
$ cd FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64
```

2. Run the installer with the options you want:

```
$ ./install.sh                      # guided, like Method B
$ ./install.sh --appimage --silent    # just for me, no questions
$ ./install.sh --deb --silent         # for everyone, no questions (asks for sudo
password)
$ ./install.sh --help               # all options
```

Option	Meaning
`--deb`	System-wide install (the `.deb` package)
`--appimage`	Just-for-me install (the AppImage)
`--silent` or `-y`	Don't ask anything; use defaults
`--gui` / `--cli`	Force graphical windows / terminal questions
`--launch` / `--no-launch`	Start (or don't offer to start) FlowNote at the end

> **Note**
> Advanced users can also install the packages directly: `sudo apt install ./FlowNote-<version>-amd64.deb`, or make the `.AppImage` executable and run it. The installer does this for you and also adds the menu entry, the `flownote` command and an uninstaller.

2.4 Check that it worked

- ☐ **FlowNote** appears in your application menu.
- ☐ Typing `flownote` in a new terminal starts it. (Just-for-me install: if the command isn't found, log out and in again once, or use `~/.local/bin/flownote`.)
- ☐ FlowNote opens with empty *Folders* and *Pages* panels, or with your existing notes after an upgrade.

2.5 Where FlowNote is installed

	For everyone (.deb)	Just for me (AppImage)
Program	`/opt/FlowNote`	`~/.local/opt/flownote`
Command	`/usr/bin/flownote`	`~/.local/bin/flownote`
Uninstaller	`uninstall.sh` in the bundle, or `sudo apt remove flownote`	`~/.local/opt/flownote/uninstall.sh`
Your notes (both)	`~/.config/@flownote/electron/`	
Install log (both)	`~/.cache/flownote-install.log`	

3. Installing on Windows

Choose **one** method. Method A suits almost everyone.

3.1 Method A: setup wizard (recommended)

1. **Download** `FlowNote-<version>-windows-x64.zip`.
2. **Unzip it.** Right-click the zip → **Extract All…** → **Extract**. A folder with the same name opens.
3. **Start setup.** Double-click `FlowNote_<version>_x64-setup.exe`.
4. **SmartScreen warning.** Preview builds aren't code-signed yet, so Windows may show *"Windows protected your PC"*. Click **More info**, check the app name says FlowNote, then click **Run anyway**.
5. **Language.** Choose English, Deutsch, Français or Español and click **OK**.

6. **Welcome page.** Click **Next**.
7. **Release notice.** Read it and click **I Agree**.
8. **Install location.** Keep the suggested folder (in your user profile, no admin rights needed) or click **Browse…** to choose another. Click **Next**.
9. **Start Menu folder.** Keep *FlowNote* and click **Install**.
10. **Wait** a few seconds while files are copied.
11. **Finish.** Tick **Create desktop shortcut** if you want an icon on the desktop. Leave **Run FlowNote** ticked and click **Finish**.

> **Tip**
> Your **Start Menu** → **FlowNote** folder now contains *FlowNote*, *FlowNote User Guide*, *FlowNote Feature Guide* and *Uninstall FlowNote*.

3.2 Method B: MSI package (all users / IT departments)

1. Unzip the download as above.
2. Double-click `FlowNote_<version>_x64_en-US.msi`.
3. Click through the installer: **Next** → accept the release notice → **Next** → **Install**.
4. Click **Yes** when Windows asks for administrator permission (the MSI installs for every user of the PC).
5. Click **Finish**, then open FlowNote from the Start Menu.

3.3 Method C: unattended install

For scripts and managed deployments, open **PowerShell** or **Command Prompt** in the unzipped folder:

```
# per user, no admin, no windows shown
PS> .\FlowNote_<version>_x64-setup.exe /S

# all users (run as administrator)
PS> msiexec /i FlowNote_<version>_x64_en-US.msi /qn /norestart
```

3.4 Check that it worked

- ☐ **FlowNote** appears in the Start Menu (and on the desktop, if you chose a shortcut).
- ☐ **Settings** → **Apps** → **Installed apps** lists *FlowNote* with the version you installed.
- ☐ FlowNote opens with empty *Folders* and *Pages* panels, or with your existing notes after an upgrade.

3.5 Where FlowNote is installed

	Setup wizard	MSI
Program	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\FlowNote` (unless you changed it)	`C:\Program Files\FlowNote`
Your notes (both)	`%APPDATA%\com.sandeep.flownote\`	

4. Updating and backing up

4.1 Updating to a new version

1. Close FlowNote (the installer also closes it for you if it's running).
2. Download the new version and install it exactly as described above, using the **same install type** as before.
   - Linux: the installer says *"FlowNote x is installed. Upgrade it to y?"*; answer **Yes**.
   - Windows: run the new setup wizard; it replaces the old version.
3. Open FlowNote. Your folders and pages are all still there.

Running the installer for the version you already have offers to **repair** it, which fixes a damaged install without touching your notes.

4.2 Backing up your notes

1. Close FlowNote.
2. Copy the whole notes folder to a USB drive or another safe place:
   - Linux: `~/.config/@flownote/electron/` (in the file manager press `Ctrl` + `H` to show hidden folders)
   - Windows: type `%APPDATA%\com.sandeep.flownote` into the File Explorer address bar
3. To restore, close FlowNote and copy the folder back to the same place.

For automatic, encrypted backups across computers, set up **Backup & Sync** (View → Sync…) as described in the User Guide.

5. Uninstalling

> **Important**
> Uninstalling removes the program but **keeps your notes** unless you choose to delete them. Reinstalling later brings them back automatically.

5.1 Linux

1. Close FlowNote.
2. Start the uninstaller. Any one of:
   - Double-click `uninstall.sh` in the unpacked bundle folder (choose **Run**).
   - Just-for-me install: run `~/.local/opt/flownote/uninstall.sh` (works without the download).
   - In a terminal in the bundle folder: `./uninstall.sh`
3. **Confirm** that you want to remove FlowNote.
4. **Choose what happens to your notes**: answer **No** to keep them (default), or **Yes** to delete them permanently.
5. Enter your password if asked (system-wide install only). A final message confirms that FlowNote is uninstalled.

```
$ ./uninstall.sh --keep-data      # remove FlowNote, keep notes, no questions about them
$ ./uninstall.sh --remove-data    # remove FlowNote and delete notes
$ sudo apt remove flownote        # system-wide install only, keeps notes
```

5.2 Windows

1. Close FlowNote.
2. Open **Start** → **FlowNote** → **Uninstall FlowNote**, or **Settings** → **Apps** → **Installed apps**, click ⋯ next to FlowNote and choose **Uninstall**.
3. On the confirmation page, tick **Delete the application data** only if you also want to delete your notes.
4. Click **Uninstall**, then **Close** when it's done.

Alternatively, double-click **Uninstall FlowNote.cmd** in the unzipped download folder. It finds either kind of install (wizard or MSI) and shows a small window with an *Also delete my notes* checkbox. For scripts:

```
PS> powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\Uninstall-FlowNote.ps1 -Silent -KeepData
PS> powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\Uninstall-FlowNote.ps1 -Silent -
RemoveData
```

6. Solving installation problems

6.1 Linux

Problem	Solution
Double-clicking the `.run` file opens a text editor or does nothing	It isn't executable yet: see Method A step 2, or run `chmod +x FlowNote-*.run`. Some file managers need you to pick **Run** or **Execute** when asked.
No installer windows appear, only terminal questions	Neither `zenity` nor `kdialog` is installed. Answer in the terminal, or install one: `sudo apt install zenity`.
"These packages are built for 64-bit PCs"	FlowNote currently needs an x86_64 computer; ARM devices (e.g. Raspberry Pi) aren't supported yet.
The system-wide install fails	Check your password and that no other update/software centre is running, then try again. Or choose **Just for me**. Details are in `~/.cache/flownote-install.log`.
"The system install needs apt"	Your distribution isn't Debian/Ubuntu-based. Use the **Just for me** install.
Note about FUSE 2 during install; FlowNote starts slowly	Optional speed-up: `sudo apt install libfuse2t64` (Ubuntu 24.04+) or `libfuse2` (older), then run the installer again.
`flownote: command not found`	Just-for-me install: log out and back in, or run `~/.local/bin/flownote`. FlowNote is also in the app menu.

6.2 Windows

Problem	Solution
"Windows protected your PC"	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. Preview installers aren't code-signed yet.
Setup says FlowNote is running	Close FlowNote (check Task Manager if no window is open), or let setup close it, then continue.
The MSI asks for an administrator	The MSI installs for all users. Use the setup wizard instead for a per-user install without admin rights.
Antivirus blocks the installer	Make sure the file came from the official download and its checksum matches, then allow it in your antivirus.
FlowNote doesn't start on Windows 10	Install Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime from microsoft.com, then start FlowNote again.
`Uninstall-FlowNote.ps1` "cannot be loaded because running scripts is disabled"	Use **Uninstall FlowNote.cmd**, or start PowerShell with `-ExecutionPolicy Bypass` as shown above.

Still stuck? Open an issue at `github.com/sandeep12biswas/noteApp` and attach `~/.cache/flownote-install.log` (Linux) or a screenshot of the error (Windows).